

Organization and Management Exam Notes

ME 708 · IV-I (BEL, BEX, BCT, BEI) · TU, IOE · tiers over 29 papers, 2065–2082 BS

4. Case Studies

2 hrs · asked in **14 of 29 papers** · 5 syllabus topics · **92 marks, 3.9% of the archive** → small, but a near-certain 4-mark short note since 2079.

READ THIS FIRST

Only two things are ever asked, in rotation: **objectives of case study** (8 papers) and **steps / phases of case study** (5 papers, all since 2079). Learn the **6 steps** and the **5 phases** as two separate numbered lists; examiners use both words. Twice a paper has set an applied 8-marker (prepare a case study of NEA or Nepal Telecom; recommend improvements for your college): answer it by filling in the **report structure** of §4.3.

Tier chips count **papers out of 29**: **TOP n/29** 8+ **HOT n/29** 4–7 **PIN n/29** 1–3 inside an 8-mark question. Bold year = Regular exam.

4.1 Introduction and Objectives

What is a case study? Why are case studies conducted? Objectives and value of case study **2 3 4**

TOP 8/29 81 Ba, 80 Ba, 73 Ch, 71 Ch, 71 Shr, 70 Asa, 69 Ch, 66 Bh · short note in 71 Shr, 69 Ch, 66 Bh ("value of case study")

Meaning

- A **case** = written description of a **real management situation**: facts, reports, even opinions, but **no evaluation**.
- **Case study method**: learners analyse the case, identify problems, weigh alternatives and **decide**, as a manager would.
- Belief behind it: managerial competence comes from studying and discussing **actual situations**, not only theory.
- Also a **research method**: in-depth study of one unit (firm, project, event) to understand causes or test a hypothesis.
- Harvard Business School made it the standard method of management teaching (1920s) **verified/added**.

Why conducted (AJ Sir)

- Teach managerial skills: **analyse** a situation, **frame** the right questions, **find answers**, **make decisions**.
- Link the three foundations of management practice: **research, theory, practice**.

Types of case studies **2**

PIN 1/29 80 Ba

- **Illustrative**: descriptive; one or two instances show what a situation is like; makes the unfamiliar familiar.
- **Exploratory (pilot)**: short study before a large investigation, to find the right questions and measures.
Risk: early findings released as conclusions.

Teaching cases may also be classed as **incident** (short event), **problem / decision** (choose an action), **appraisal** (evaluate a situation) and **descriptive** cases.

Objectives

1. **Impart knowledge and facts** about real organizations.
2. Develop **problem analysis** skill: separate symptoms from causes.
3. Develop **decision-making** skill under incomplete information.
4. Improve **communication**: discuss, defend, write reports.
5. Shape **attitude**: nothing in human behaviour is absolutely right or wrong; respect other views.
6. Apply **theory to practice**; test principles against reality.
7. Build **teamwork** and judgement through group discussion.

Value (short note, 66 Bh)

- + realistic, active learning; develops analytical thinking; learner participates; many solutions welcome; bridges classroom and industry.
- – time consuming (gathering, arranging, writing facts is long and tedious); needs a skilled discussion leader; one case may not generalize.

- **Cumulative**: combines past studies from several sites and times → wider generalization at no new cost.
- **Critical instance**: one or a few sites of unique interest, or to challenge a universal claim; answers cause-effect questions.

4.2 Phases and Steps of Case Study

Explain the phases and steps of case study, with an example from your field 4 5 8

HOT 5/29 82 Bh, 81 Bh, 81 Ba, 80 Bh, 79 Bh · short note in 82 Bh, 81 Bh · every paper since 2079 except 80 Ba

Five phases (group discussion)

1. **Study the details:** each member reads the case. What is happening? What more data is needed?
2. **Collect additional facts:** ask the discussion leader; organize facts by relevance to the decision.
3. **Define the problem:** the group agrees on the real problem and phrases the critical questions.
4. **Individual decisions:** each writes "How would I handle it? How would I support my decision?"; members with the same view form sub-groups and argue their case.
5. **Learn from the whole case:** "How could more have been achieved?"

Six steps (individual analysis)

1. **State the problem:** what is the case about, what must be done or answered.
2. **Collect and analyse data:** arrange facts systematically; separate facts from opinions.
3. **Formulate tentative solutions:** list all alternatives, keep an open mind.
4. **Select the recommended solution:** best answer to the stated problem on the given data.
5. **Prepare the written report.**
6. **Checklist:** what does the solution achieve? what difficulties must be overcome? what limits (time, money, equipment, manpower)? is it the best alternative?

Example from engineering: why did a hydropower project finish two years late? **verified/added**

Step	Applied
1 State the problem	60 MW project, planned 4 years, took 6; cost overrun 40%. Why, and how to prevent it next time?
2 Collect and analyse data	Schedule vs actual (Gantt), change orders, land-acquisition dates, contractor payments, site logs, interviews with engineers and locals. Finding: land dispute (8 months), tunnel geology surprise (10 months), late payments → contractor slowdown.
3 Tentative solutions	(a) better geological survey; (b) settle land before tender; (c) escrow payment to contractor; (d) matrix project organization with one accountable manager.
4 Recommended solution	Combine (a)+(b) as pre-construction gates, (c) for cash flow; (d) as the structure.
5 Written report	Background, problem, data, analysis, recommendations, implementation plan.
6 Checklist	Achieves on-time completion; needs upfront survey budget; limit: political land issues; still the best alternative.

4.3 Case Report Writing, and Preparing a Case Study

Prepare a case study of an organization (NEA / Nepal Telecom; your college) following the case structure 8

PIN 2/29 74 Ch, 72 Ch · applied 8-markers: fill in the structure

Case report writing methodology

1. **Organizational background:** goals, formation, structure, social value, history, financial position.
2. **Identification of the problem.**
3. **Hypothesis:** the suspected cause.
4. **Case research design:** what data, from whom, how.
5. **Collection and analysis of data.**
6. **Generalization and interpretation.**
7. **Conclusions and recommendations.**

NEA or Nepal Telecom (72 Ch): planning horizon, leadership, motivation, HRD

- **Background:** NEA, government-owned (NEA Act 2041), generation, transmission, distribution; long load-shedding (up to 18 h/day in 2015–16).
- **Problem:** poor performance: losses, leakage (about 25% system loss), load-shedding, low morale.
- **Hypothesis:** weak leadership and short planning horizon, not only lack of power.
- **Data:** supply-demand, loss figures, staff surveys, interviews.

Typical report titles (a full O&M case study)

Acknowledgement; organization (history, objectives, input-process-output); structure (chart); form of ownership; personnel policies; manpower planning; recruitment and selection; training; job evaluation; merit rating; wages and incentives; motivation; marketing; leadership; MIS; drawbacks; suggestions; conclusion; references.

- **Planning horizon:** short term (cut leakage, import power, manage dispatch); medium (transmission lines); long (new generation, export).
- **Leadership:** decisive, visible, results-driven MD ended load-shedding in 2016–18 through leakage control and better dispatch: a lesson in leadership.
- **Motivation:** performance targets per distribution centre, recognition, incentives, protection from political interference.
- **HRD:** technical training, merit-based promotion, succession planning.
- **Recommendations** + implementation plan and monitoring.

Recommendations to your college management (74 Ch) 8

- Frame it as a case: **background** (programmes, students, faculty), **problems** observed over 3+ years, **analysis**, **recommendations**.
- **Academic:** regular classes and full-time faculty; faculty training; updated labs; industry projects and internships; continuous assessment.
- **Infrastructure:** library e-resources, internet, classrooms, hostels.
- **Student support:** counselling, career cell, alumni network, clubs.
- **Research:** research grants, publication support, MoUs with industry.
- **Management:** MIS for attendance and results, student feedback, transparent fees, accreditation (UGC QAA).
- **Image:** website, social media, results publicity, community programmes.
- Close with priorities and a time-bound plan.

4.4 PYQ Mapping

Theory questions, covered in this document

- **What is a case study, why conducted, objectives, value** → §4.1. 8 papers; three of them as a 4-mark short note.
- **Types of case studies** 80 Ba 2 → §4.1.
- **Phases and steps, with an example from your field** → §4.2. 82 Bh 4, 81 Bh 4, 81 Ba 5, 80 Bh 8, 79 Bh 8
- **Prepare a case study of NEA / Nepal Telecom; recommendations for your college** 74 Ch 8, 72 Ch 8 → §4.3.
- 73 Ch and 71 Ch pair case-study objectives with MIS needs; the MIS half is in Ch. 5.

Numerical content

- **This chapter has no numerical component.**

Sources

- Adhikari pp259–272 and AJ Sir's 7-slide deck cover all five syllabus topics between them. S.K. Joshi's textbook follows an older syllabus and has no case-study chapter, so nothing was taken from it here.

Abbreviations, chips and month codes

Only these are ever shortened. Anything not on this list is written out in full.

Short	Means	Short	Means
JSC	joint stock company	MNC	multinational company
HR, HRM	human resource (management)	OB	organizational behaviour
MBO	management by objectives	CEO, MD	chief executive officer, managing director
AGM	annual general meeting	ESOP	employee share ownership plan
MoA, AoA	memorandum / articles of association	OCR	Office of the Company Registrar
SEBON	Securities Board of Nepal	NEPSE	Nepal Stock Exchange
IPO	initial public offering	PAN, VAT	permanent account no., value added tax
NEA	Nepal Electricity Authority	NOC	Nepal Oil Corporation
QC	quality control	R&D	research and development
OR	operations research	ROI	return on investment
CIM	computer integrated manufacturing	FMS	flexible manufacturing system
CAD, CAM	computer aided design / manufacturing	CAPP	computer aided process planning
CNC	computer numerical control	AGV	automated guided vehicle
MIS	management information system	IT	information technology
SaaS	software as a service	BPO	business process outsourcing
CSR	corporate social responsibility	POSDCoRB	plan, organize, staff, direct, coordinate, report, budget

Short	Means	Short	Means
no.	number	info	information
vs, Vs	versus	Eg	example / for example
+Fig	draw a figure	(I)	importance / need / significance
→	leads to / therefore	+	and
=	is / equals	min, max	minimum, maximum
Ch.	chapter	§	section

Chip	Means (29 papers, 2065–2082 BS)
TOP n/29	asked in 8 or more papers
HOT n/29	asked in 4 to 7 papers
PIN n/29	asked in 1 to 3 papers, inside an 8-mark question
LOW n/29	asked in 1 to 3 papers, as a 4-mark short note only
syllabus, no PYQ yet	in the syllabus, never examined
4+4	marks as printed; several chips = the question recurred at different marks
verified/added	researched and added beyond the lecture notes
80 Bh	bold year = Regular exam; plain = Back exam

Months: Ba = Baishakh, Jth = Jestha, Asa = Ashad, Shr = Shrawan, Bh = Bhadra, Ash = Ashwin, Ka = Kartik, Mng = Mangsir, Po = Poush, Ma = Magh, Ch = Chaitra. **Ash and Asa are different months.** **Sources:** AJ Sir = AJ Sir's lecture decks; Adhikari = Bikash Adhikari, *Organization and Management* slide notes; Joshi = S.K. Joshi, *Organization and Management*, A.K. Books.